trying to extract information regarding my brother. Nobody would believe us when we used to tell them that we do not know. Mustafa knew that we were the prime suspects so he would never tell us anything.'

'Then where have these arms and ammunition come from, which we recovered from your fields?'

'We do not know. I swear by the name of Allah that my father is innocent.'

I pounced on this statement. 'That means one of you is involved. Mustafa's associates must have been coming to you and asking you to run errands for them. To act as couriers for them.' The last part was a bit of a bluff, the effect of watching too many detective serials on TV.

'No, No. None of us is involved,' she replied emphatically. 'There was a rumour once that a girl in a burkha was running errands and the finger of suspicion pointed towards us. But once, when the girl was unveiled by mistake, it transpired that she was from a neighbouring village.'

I asked Razzaq for the details of the girl and the village and handed it over to my second-in-command, Lt Col Narendra Parmar to run a detailed check with the police. He came back a little while later. Yes, there was a girl by that name in the village and it was said that she was sweet on Mustafa. The story could well be true. Everything seemed to be checking out, but how would we account for the weapons we had recovered the previous day? And what was I to do with Razzaq Khan? Book him, an innocent man? Or leave him, to fight us again another day? Decisions, decisions!

While the family sat and chatted outside the post, we retired inside for some serious discussions. The Company Commander, Maj AS Pundir, who had nabbed Razzaq, was dead set against letting him go. He wanted to book him with everything under

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